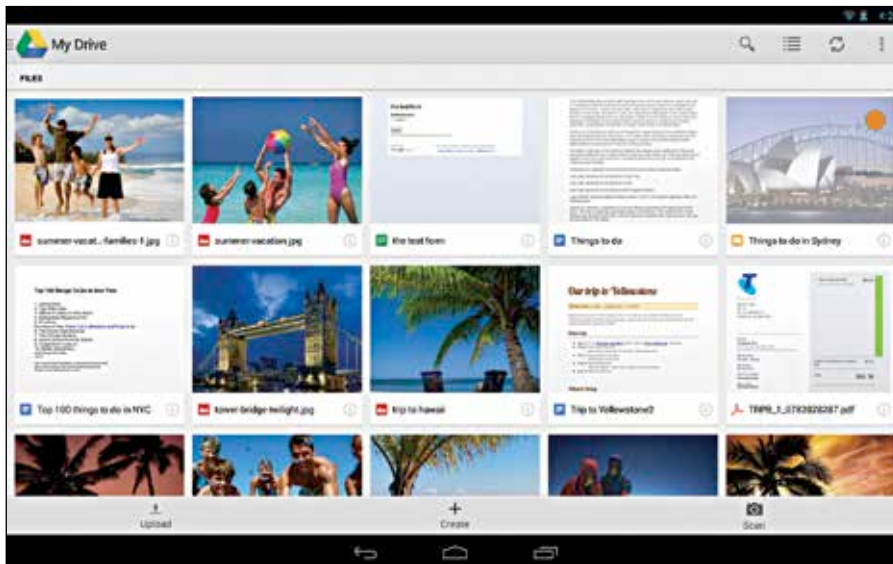




Google Drive on the mobile just requires you to install a single app to be able to access and work on all your files.

On the iPhone and iPad, all three iWork apps are available as separate downloads from the App Store. Even though the apps do feel like they deserve larger real estate than an iPhone's 3.5 or 4-in screen, there's no doubt that these are the best productivity apps for touchscreen devices. The intuitive design of the apps sparkle on the iPad and it's quite amazing how fluidly Keynote and Numbers work. This is also the only mobile app suite (among the three) that lets you create presentations.

Score: Office365 2 - Drive 2 - iWork 1

Collaboration

Collaboration is pretty much the 'buzz word' for productivity suites and Office 365 obliges. You can invite other users to start working on a document/spreadsheet/presentation with you, by saving the file in SkyDrive and then emailing the link to the other users. The users will then be able to work on the file either in Word (provided they too have Office 2013 installed) or online in the Word Web app (for which they require their own Microsoft ID). While this sounds fine, in

practice, we stumbled across multiple connection issues which meant collaboration was almost impossible. Also, real-time collaboration (as you witness in Google Drive) doesn't exist.

Google Drive, on the other hand, does a fine, fine job at collaboration. Just invite other Google users through email, and they'll be led by the hand to your file through an email. Real-time collaboration tools such as live chat and notes work flawlessly and when we say, real-time, we mean real-time as in when other users begin typing on your file, and you see the changes almost instantaneously.

Apple allows for collaboration through the iWork for iCloud service that, surprisingly, works seamlessly. Go to iCloud.com, sign in, open a document and click the share button. This allows you to email a link of the file to anyone, yes, even someone without an Apple ID. This person can then start working on the document at the same time as you and you will see the changes real-time. Drive wins here again, but iWork is a worthy mention.

Score: Office365 2 - Drive 3 - iWork 1

Conclusion

The battle for the best productivity suite is quite a tough one as can be seen above and it feels a bit unfair to just name one as undoubtedly the best. Therefore, let us cheat a bit and give you three winners across three different use-case scenarios.

If you're looking for a powerful, full-featured productivity suite and plan to work primarily offline on your desktop or laptop, go for Microsoft Office 365. If you're a home or student user, then choose the free Google Drive.

If you're looking for a basic productivity suite that compromises on features to give you excellent accessibility and you don't mind always working online, then Google Drive is quite obviously the choice for you.

If you already own an iPad and other Apple devices, and want to work on it while on the go, then the iWork suite of apps will allow you pretty decent productivity for a decent price.

At gunpoint, if asked to choose only of the suites as the winner, we're in unanimous agreement that Google Drive is by far the suite we wouldn't want to live without. Plus, it's free and easy to use! 



Not only are the iWork apps exceptionally good on iOS, Keynote beats every other presentation tool hands down.